

Like father, like daughter: Yibbi is the daughter of hockey legend Ronald Jansen, who won Olympic gold in 1996 and 2000, and bronze in 1988 with the Oranje. GETTY IMAGES



when I'm on the field. I train a lot on it. There are times when you have to make a small addition or change a few things, and then the quality of the drag-flick suddenly goes a bit down. But in the end, it's all about getting better at it," the 25-year-old said.

Does Ronald also play a part in fine-tuning her technique at the dinner table? "Sometimes. We have the usual dad-and-daughter talk. Most of the time, it's not about hockey because he has his own opinion, and I have mine. It can sometimes clash. But it's nice to talk to someone who has experienced it all. However, the times are very different... He played hockey some 25 years ago."

While Yibbi has traced her father's footsteps in her professional career, she understands that many little girls from even the most obscure corners of India would want to follow in her footsteps. She said, "First, I was just a

YIBBI JANSEN FACED RESISTANCE WHEN SHE TOLD HER FAMILY SHE WANTED TO PURSUE THE SPORT DESPITE COMING FROM DUTCH HOCKEY ROYALTY

young player looking up to other girls, and now I've come to the position where girls look up to me. But hopefully, I give them some of my experience and teach them some useful skills. I did, for example, do some drag-flicking with Annu (22-year-old India and Warriors forward). It's just nice that you can give them some tips. Hopefully, they get their sense of it and make the Indian team later."

Yibbi, meanwhile, draws

inspiration from everyone around her. "I like to watch other athletes as well, not just hockey players. From football, I like (Lionel) Messi, for example, but every other person can inspire you. If you read a book or just watch someone performing day in and day out, every week, every game... it's just so inspiring."

As Yibbi continues to tick off milestones one after another, there's little doubt as to where Aladdin's magic lamp resides right now.